catastrophic consequences around the planet. Should that trajectory not be arrested, the prospect of human extinction looms on the horizon.

The Cuban Missile Crisis: To Armageddon and Beyond explores another existential danger to humanity and suggests that ‘our greatest threat in thousands of years’ was (and may well remain) the threat of thermonuclear war. With North Korea’s acquisition of nuclear weapons and the Russian invasion of Ukraine in February 2022, there has been, for the first time in decades, public discussion in the West and elsewhere of the prospect of nuclear war. So this is a good time for people to discover (or reacquaint themselves with) the history of the nuclear age.